

Objection 3: God might
give eternal reward to
believers and
nonbelievers alike.

Setting aside the possibility of No reward God, which we have seen to be irrelevant, taking account of the possibility of Generous God has a striking effect on the expected utilities of belief and nonbelief.

Now, it appears, **belief and nonbelief have the same infinite expected utility**, which undercuts

Pascal's argument for the rationality of belief in God.

However, Pascal seems to have a reasonable reply to this objection. It seems that the objection turns on the fact that any probability times an infinite utility will yield an infinite expected value. And that means that any two actions which have some chance of bring about an infinite reward will have the same expected utility.

But that does not mean we should be indifferent between the choices. Suppose we think of a pair of lotteries, EASY and HARD. Each lottery has an infinite payoff, but EASY has a $1/3$ chance of winning, whereas HARD has a $1/1,000,000$ chance of winning. What is the expected utility of EASY vs. HARD?

Which would you be more rational to buy a ticket for?

A natural suggestion is to say something like this: if two actions each have infinite expected utility, then (supposing that neither action has a very high chance of leading to a very bad outcome) it is rational to go with the action that has the higher probability of leading to the infinite reward. This explains our preference for EASY over HARD; and it also helps Pascal solve the problem of Generous God.



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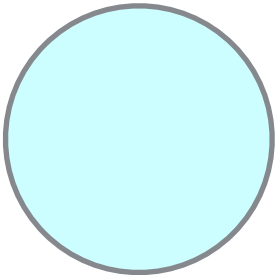
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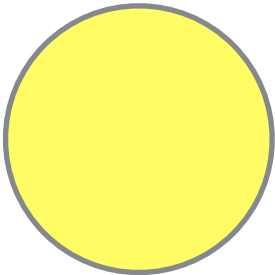




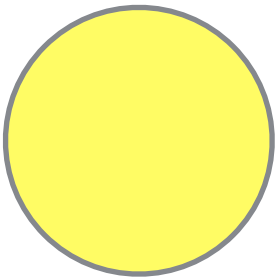
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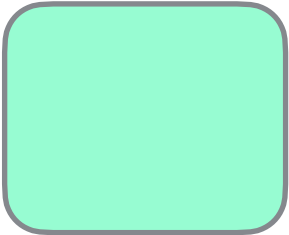


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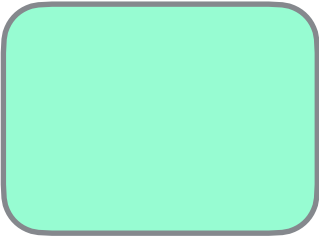
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Goodbye

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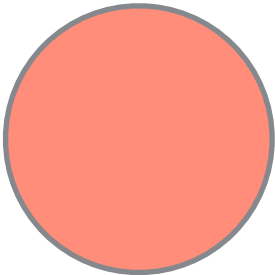












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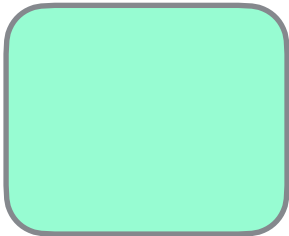
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Gravitas





